

A function sends a *return value* back to the line that called the function, so the value can be used later in the code. The calling line uses a variable to store the return value.

This function accepts a rectangle's width and height and returns the area:

```
def area_rect(w, h):  
    """Calculate the area of a rectangle."""  
    area = w * h  
    return area  
  
my_area = area_rect(5, 4)  
print(my_area)
```

When the function is called, the return value is stored in the variable `my_area`. Here's the output:

```
20
```

You can return any kind of value. To return more than one value, place the values in parentheses to return them as a tuple.